



Annamalai University

RPE-Research and Publication Ethics

Compulsory for all Ph.D. students for pre-registration course work.

Course Objectives:

- To impart knowledge on research ethics, academic conduct and Integrity.
- To sensitize the scholars about their responsibilities to science, society and ecosystem.
- To equip the scholars with techniques and skills to avoid ethical misconduct.
- To provide hands on experience in the use various software tools in research and publication process.
- To acquaint participants with tools and techniques popularly utilized for ensuring academic standards, avoiding plagiarism, and promoting high impact publication.

Course Outcomes:

At the end of the course the scholar:

- Will be able to identify the ethical issues in research process based on the concept of philosophy and ethics.
- Will be able to avoid scientific misconduct like fabrication, falsification and fraud in the research process by following the recommended guidelines.
- Will be able to use tools like Reference Management, Journal Identification, Open Access, Plagiarism Checker and avoid misconduct.
- Will be able to communicate the research findings in approved journals with high journal metrics and also improve the author metrics.

Credit load : 30 hours (50% theory and 50% Practical)

Delivery mode: Team Teaching - Inter Disciplinary by Faculty members with Ph.D having more than 10 years of teaching experience / BSR Research Fellows / Guest Speakers / Top 2% Scientist in the University.

Pedagogy : Class room teaching, guest lectures, group discussions and practical sessions.

Evaluation : Continuous assessment will be done through tutorials, assignments, quizzes and group discussions.

Marking Scheme: As per the existing course work.

Syllabus

Unit 1 PHILOSOPHY, ETHICS & SCIENTIFIC CONDUCT

Introduction to philosophy: definition, nature and scope, concept, branches - **Ethics:** definition, moral philosophy, nature of moral judgments and reactions - **Ethics with respect to science and research** - Intellectual honesty and research integrity - **Scientific misconducts:** Falsification, Fabrication, and Plagiarism (FFP) - **Redundant Publications:** duplicate and overlapping publications, salami slicing - Selective reporting and misrepresentation of data

Unit 2 PUBLICATION ETHICS

Publication ethics: definition, introduction and importance - **Best practices/ standard setting initiatives and guidelines:** COPE, WAME, etc. - **Conflict of Interest** - **Publication misconduct:** definition, concept, problems that lead to unethical behavior and vice versa, types - **Violation of publication ethics,** complaints and appeals - Identification of publication misconduct, complaints and appeals - **Predatory publication and journals**

Unit 3 OPEN ACCESS PUBLISHING

Open access publication and initiatives - SHERPA/RoMEO Online resource to check publisher copyright & self-archiving policies - **Software tool to identify predatory publications** developed by SPPU - Journal finder / journal suggestion tool viz. JANE, Elsevier Journal Finder, Springer Journal Suggestion, etc.

Unit 4 PUBLICATION MISCONDUCT

Group Discussions - **Subject specific ethical issues,** FFP, authorship - **Conflicts of interest** - **Complaints and appeals:** examples and fraud from India and abroad - **Software tools** - Use of plagiarism software like Turnitin, Urkund and other open source software tools.

Unit 5 DATABASES AND RESEARCH METRICS

Databases - **Indexing databases** - Citation databases: Web of Science, Scopus, etc., - **Research Metrics (Journal)** - Impact Factor of journal as per Journal Citation Report, SNIP, SJR, IPP, Cite Score - **Research Metrics (Author)** - Metrics: h- Index, i10 index, altmetrics.